city's municipality was galvanized into cleanliness. Ashoka would naturally never have experienced first-hand the normal state of insanitation in Taxila.

Was royalty expected to pay obeisance at the temple at Taxila, the most prominent public space in the city? The city brimmed with deities. Goddesses outnumbered gods. Miniature goddesses of clay outnumbered gods. Many of these were for domestic worship in homes, but also seem to have formed part of the paraphernalia of public worship at least in this most conspicuous area within the city, where the presence of an early temple is clear.

This place of worship is in the western part of the city and comprises two blocks with a narrow lane running between them. In the larger block, which is to the north, are two open courtyards, a large pillared hall on the western side of one of the courtyards, and some thirty rooms.[31] The rooms were dwelt in and the inhabitants are likely to have been the temple priests. The debris in this block yielded a number of terracotta reliefs, with a male and female deity standing side by side, so there seems little doubt about this having been a shrine. Marshall sums it all up:

> The position which it occupies alongside the street suggests . . . that it served rather as a shrine of some sort, and if this was so the house attached to it may well have been occupied by the priests and their attendants or disciples. This seems more likely because in the debris of this building, as well as among the ruins on the farther side of the lane to the west, were found a large number of terracotta reliefs representing a male and female deity standing side by side and holding hands. Such stamped reliefs were made to be sold or presented to worshippers at a shrine and to be kept by them as mementos or talismans, just as figurines of *devas* or *devis* are made and sold today in shops outside many an Indian temple. In this case it seems highly probable that the structure referred to on the opposite side of the lane was just such a shop, and this would explain why many of these plaques are found in it. If I am right in drawing this inference, then the Pillared Hall acquires an added interest as being the earliest Hindu shrine, by several centuries, of which any remains have come down to us.[32]